

Individual Report for POLI_SCI_210-0_20: Intro to Empirical Methods (Matej Jungwirth)

Project Title: **Course and Teacher Evaluations CTEC Fall 2023**

Courses Audience: **75**

Responses Received: **60**

Response Ratio: **80.0%**

Report Comments

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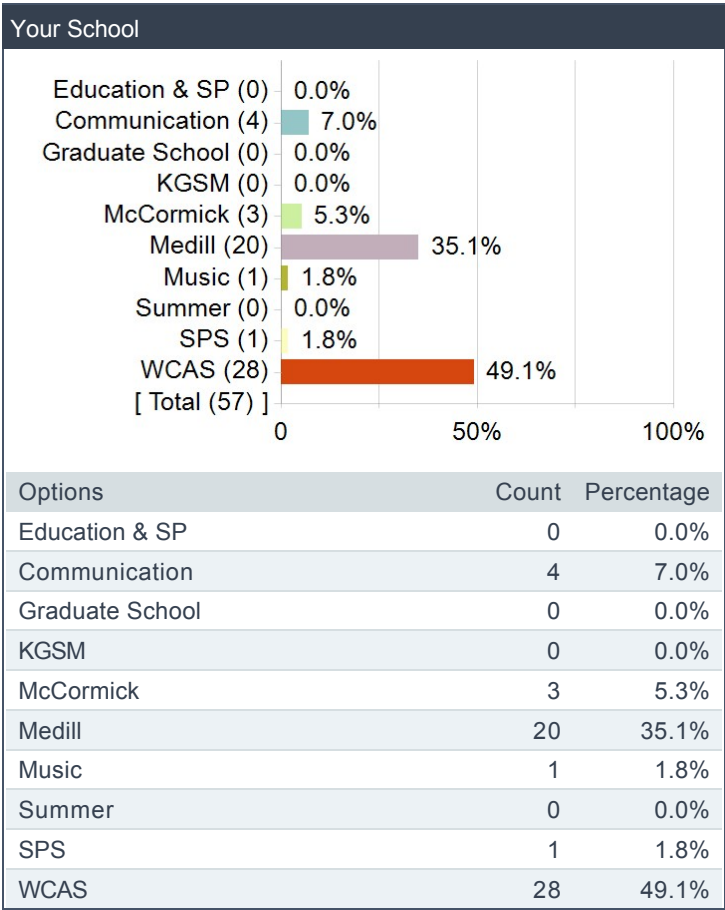
Northwestern University

Course Evaluations

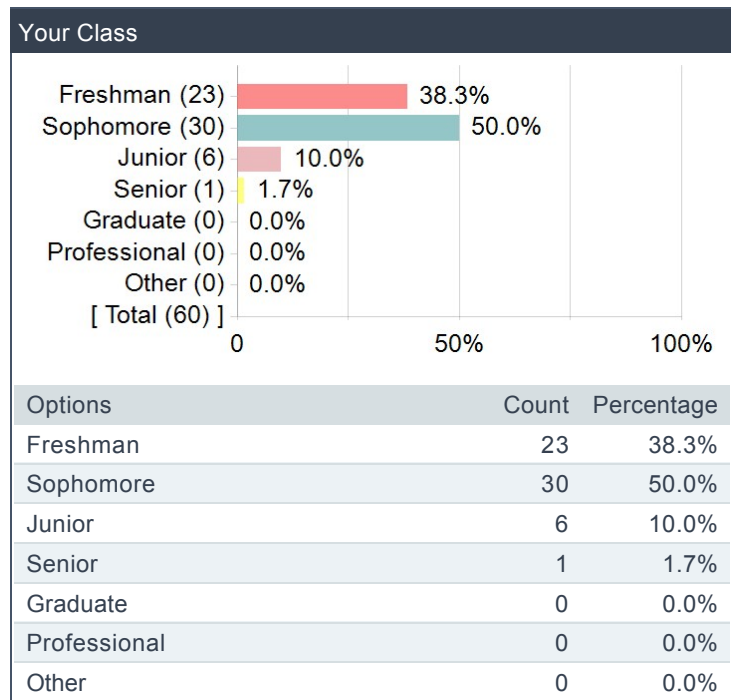
Teaching Assistant	Course
Matej Jungwirth	POLI_SCI_210-0_20: Intro to Empirical Methods

DEMOGRAPHICS

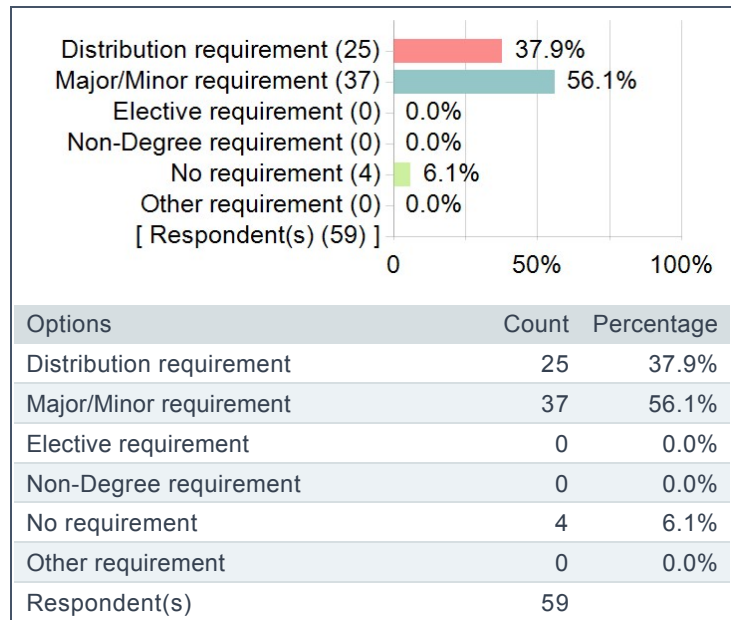
Your School



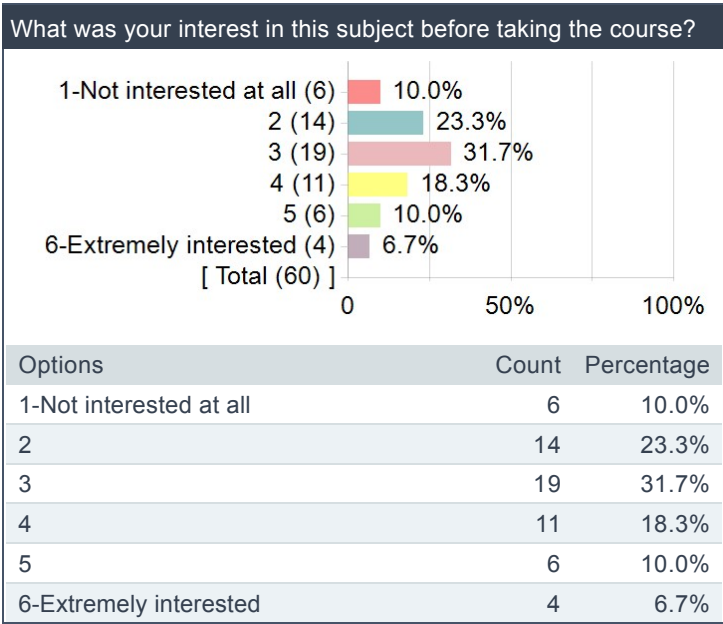
Your Class



What is your reason for taking the course? (mark all that apply)

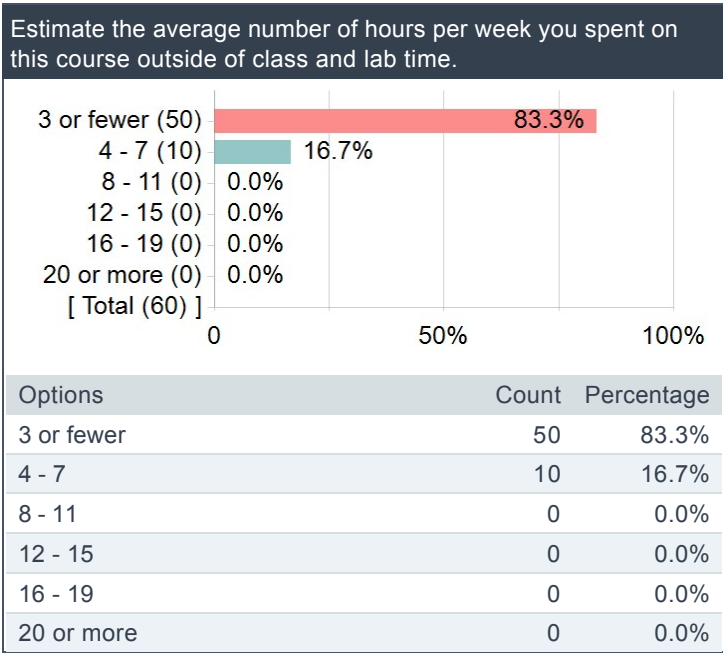


What was your interest in this subject before taking the course?



TIME-SURVEY QUESTION

Estimate the average number of hours per week you spent on this course outside of class and lab time.



TA QUESTIONS

Please rate the TA on the following criteria:

1. The TA was able to answer the students' questions adequately.					2. The TA was well prepared for each session.				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage		Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%		1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%	
2	2	0	0.0%		2	2	0	0.0%	
3	3	1	3.1%		3	3	0	0.0%	
4	4	3	9.4%		4	4	1	3.2%	
5	5	6	18.8%		5	5	3	9.7%	
6-Very High	6	22	68.8%		6-Very High	6	27	87.1%	
Statistics				Value	Statistics				Value
Response Count				32	Response Count				31
Mean				5.53	Mean				5.84
Median				6.00	Median				6.00
Standard Deviation				0.80	Standard Deviation				0.45
3. The TA communicated ideas in a clear manner.					4. The TA showed strong interest in teaching the course.				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage		Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	1	3.1%		1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%	
2	2	0	0.0%		2	2	0	0.0%	
3	3	0	0.0%		3	3	1	3.1%	
4	4	1	3.1%		4	4	3	9.4%	
5	5	6	18.8%		5	5	4	12.5%	
6-Very High	6	24	75.0%		6-Very High	6	24	75.0%	
Statistics				Value	Statistics				Value
Response Count				32	Response Count				32
Mean				5.59	Mean				5.59
Median				6.00	Median				6.00
Standard Deviation				0.98	Standard Deviation				0.80

OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

What are the primary strengths and weaknesses of the teaching assistant?

Comments
Matej was so nice, understanding, and helpful! I really appreciated how he prepared his own slideshow for each discussion section in which he not only re-reviewed the material we learned in class, but he had us practice with relevant examples and case studies. I've emailed him for help and he responds very thoroughly and in a quick and timely manner. I really appreciated his support in this class!
Super clear slides that concisely reviewed class material. Diverse class activities that solidified our understanding of class content. Some explanations were maybe a bit confusing for students, but overall positive.
Very helpful with addressing our questions about the course, sometimes felt a little disconnected from the assignments we were working on
Matej was a great TA. He was very helpful with questions in section and office hours. He had a lot of additional examples to expand upon class materials.
Amazing TA! One of the best I've ever had. Extremely prepared for section, communicated clearly, answered questions well, and seemed genuinely interested in teaching section. Matej's discussion sections were the highlight of this class.
Super understanding and always willing to help
I liked how Matej's notes were simple but still covered the week's topics nicely. He always helped me talk through any issues I had with the assignments and responded quickly to emails. I thought the feedback was helpful and that he prepared us well. I would've liked more interactive activities in the sections/discussion-based examples.
He was cool, maybe not always the most present, he also didn't grade my assignments, despite being my TA, so I felt like it was tough to respond to feedback from someone that wasn't my actual instructor or TA.
Matej was a great TA! I felt like the information from lecture was reviewed very well and the discussion was very constructive. I cannot really think of any weaknesses.
The strengths of Matej were his clear ability to answer questions and convey important topics. I wish that discussion sections focused less on other studies and more on the concepts of study and understanding them better, but I appreciated his help nonetheless.
Matej was really great at answering questions, answering emails quickly, and offering office hours. He was super helpful with the homework.
Very helpful, good slides
A lovely TA to work with that made me want to go to discussion. He was great at explaining and clearing up everything we learned during lecture.
Matej would always be prepared for discussion sections. His discussion sections, however, were not helpful in explaining what is required of a student in this course with assignments and assessments.
The TA, Matej, was very good at explaining the concepts introduced in class. He would provide examples that helped me understand the course material better. Also, he is always willing to answer questions and help whenever you are confused. The only weakness is that he does move fairly quickly with the slides and content shown in discussion.
GOAT TA. Very supportive and understanding
Super friendly and willing to help students when they needed it. Most weeks, Matej did a better job of conveying the course content than lectures did and I really enjoyed how he made sure that everyone was involved in discussions. He was very well prepared and passionate about the topic which made it easier for me to stay engaged.
Was very good at helping me understand the topic and my questions about it.
Absolutely great guy. Very smart and explained topics very well
Very kind and understanding with athletics conflicts, engages students in discussion without making anyone feel bad for having wrong answers, encourages thinking for yourself and working hard on the assignments. I don't have anything bad to say about him, he was a really great TA, and he'll be a great Prof if that's what he wants to do.
Matej was great! His discussion sections were well-thought-out and helped clarify concepts from the lecture. He was very willing to help during office hours, and he gave clear feedback on assignments.
I feel that Matej was always ready to answer our questions and was prepared for discussion. He seemed to really care about the subject and how well we were learning the concepts. Moreover, I appreciate how he uploaded our discussion slides afterward, which other TAs did not do. I feel that Matej will get increasingly better at teaching as time progresses. He already has good fundamentals and worked well with Professor Seawright.

Individual Report for POLI_SCI_210-0_1: Intro to Empirical Methods (Matej Jungwirth)

Project Title: **Course and Teacher Evaluations CTEC Winter 2024**

Courses Audience: **74**

Responses Received: **62**

Response Ratio: **83.8%**

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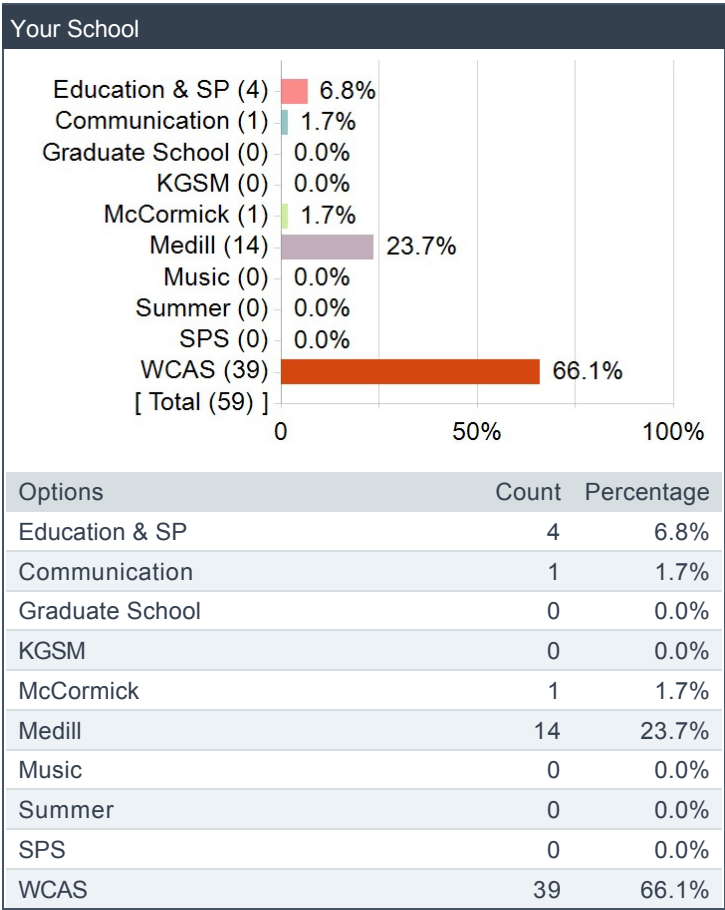
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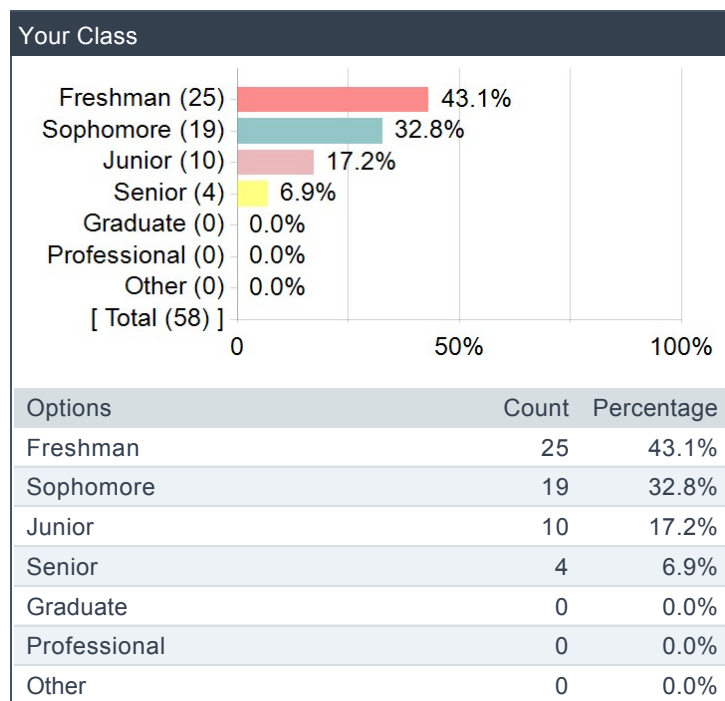
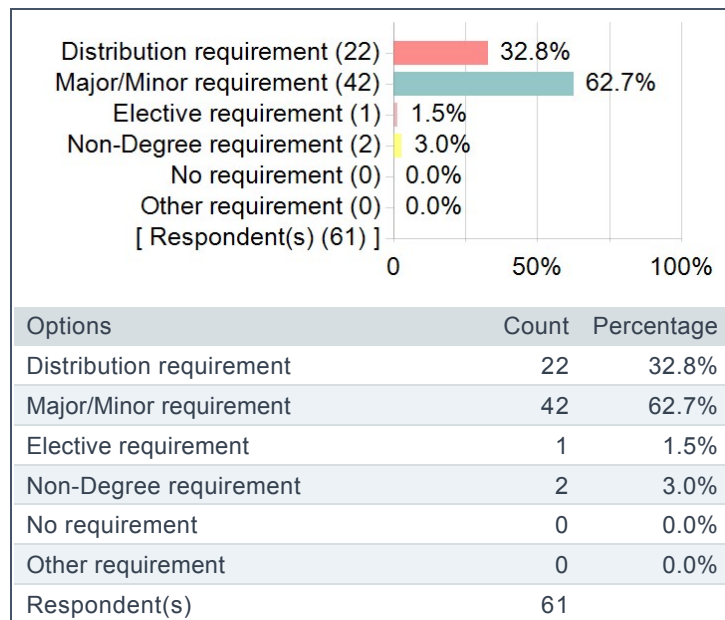
Course Evaluations

Teaching Assistant	Course
Matej Jungwirth	POLI_SCI_210-0_1: Intro to Empirical Methods

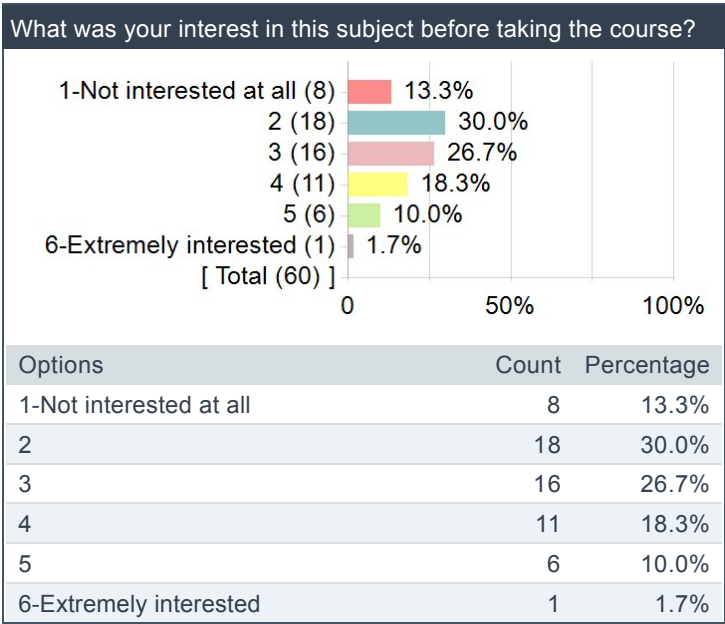
DEMOGRAPHICS

Your School



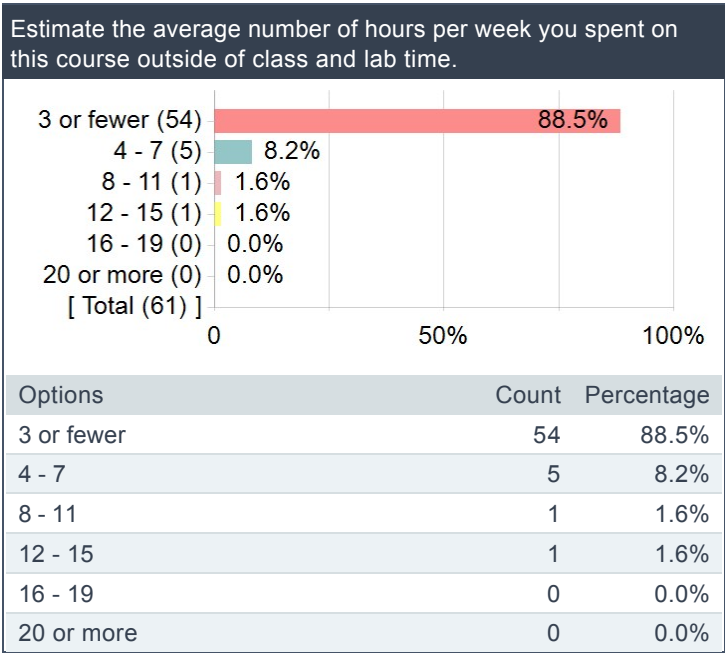
Your Class**What is your reason for taking the course? (mark all that apply)**

What was your interest in this subject before taking the course?



TIME-SURVEY QUESTION

Estimate the average number of hours per week you spent on this course outside of class and lab time.



TA QUESTIONS

Please rate the TA on the following criteria:

1. The TA was able to answer the students' questions adequately.					2. The TA was well prepared for each session.				
1-Very Low (0)0.0% 2 (0)0.0% 3 (0)0.0% 4 (0)0.0% 5 (2)18.2% 6-Very High (9)81.8% [Total (11)] 050%100%					1-Very Low (0)0.0% 2 (0)0.0% 3 (0)0.0% 4 (0)0.0% 5 (0)0.0% 6-Very High (11)100.0% [Total (11)] 050%100%				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage		Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%		1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%	
2	2	0	0.0%		2	2	0	0.0%	
3	3	0	0.0%		3	3	0	0.0%	
4	4	0	0.0%		4	4	0	0.0%	
5	5	2	18.2%		5	5	0	0.0%	
6-Very High	6	9	81.8%		6-Very High	6	11	100.0%	
Statistics				Value	Statistics				Value
Response Count				11	Response Count				11
Mean				5.82	Mean				6.00
Median				6.00	Median				6.00
Standard Deviation				0.40	Standard Deviation				0.00
3. The TA communicated ideas in a clear manner.					4. The TA showed strong interest in teaching the course.				
1-Very Low (0)0.0% 2 (0)0.0% 3 (0)0.0% 4 (0)0.0% 5 (2)18.2% 6-Very High (9)81.8% [Total (11)] 050%100%					1-Very Low (0)0.0% 2 (0)0.0% 3 (0)0.0% 4 (0)0.0% 5 (0)0.0% 6-Very High (11)100.0% [Total (11)] 050%100%				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage		Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%		1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%	
2	2	0	0.0%		2	2	0	0.0%	
3	3	0	0.0%		3	3	0	0.0%	
4	4	0	0.0%		4	4	0	0.0%	
5	5	2	18.2%		5	5	0	0.0%	
6-Very High	6	9	81.8%		6-Very High	6	11	100.0%	
Statistics				Value	Statistics				Value
Response Count				11	Response Count				11
Mean				5.82	Mean				6.00
Median				6.00	Median				6.00
Standard Deviation				0.40	Standard Deviation				0.00

OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

What are the primary strengths and weaknesses of the teaching assistant?

Comments
He was great!! I wish he was the prof of the class because he was wayyyyyyy better than the prof at explaining everything and much more interesting to listen to. I loved Matej!
Strengths: passionate and knowledgeable, able to answer questions effectively and stimulate creativity in students. Weaknesses: not clear on reasons behind grading of assignments
Strengths: passionate, knowledgeable, excellent at answering questions, always willing to help Weaknesses: very clear about a work/life division which, although respectable, makes it feel like you always have to account whether they'll respond to emails if it's a certain time/day (particularly the weekends)
Matej was the type of TA who facilitated an amazing discussion environment. It isn't often that discussions feel as interpersonal and productive as they did in Matej's section. He was incredibly well prepared and would add additional criterion to either fill in gaps of knowledge or stimulate our interest in the subject. I was so happy to have him as my TA in this course.
I feel like Matej did a better job of teaching this class than the professor. He clearly has a strong grasp on research methods and how to use them, and his ability to engage us in discussion— while easier in a section than in a lecture, to be fair— was higher than the professor as well. I felt comfortable going to him for help and clarification on certain aspects of the course, and the variety of activities in the discussion helped me to examine concepts in different ways. I would say he was probably the best TA I had this quarter, and I would highly recommend his work/ participation for future courses.
Matej was very outgoing and helpful whenever it came to subjects that were confusing or were not explained in depth during the course. He made section great and made the class a lot easier to manage, plus gave good time to the section on anything we needed to go over.
Matej was amazing! He worked incredibly well with students, cared a lot, and worked to find interactive ways for us to engage.

Individual Report for POLI_SCI_240-0_20: Intro International Relations (Matej Jungwirth)

Project Title: **Course and Teacher Evaluations CTEC Winter 2025**

Courses Audience: **164**

Responses Received: **130**

Response Ratio: **79.3%**

Report Comments

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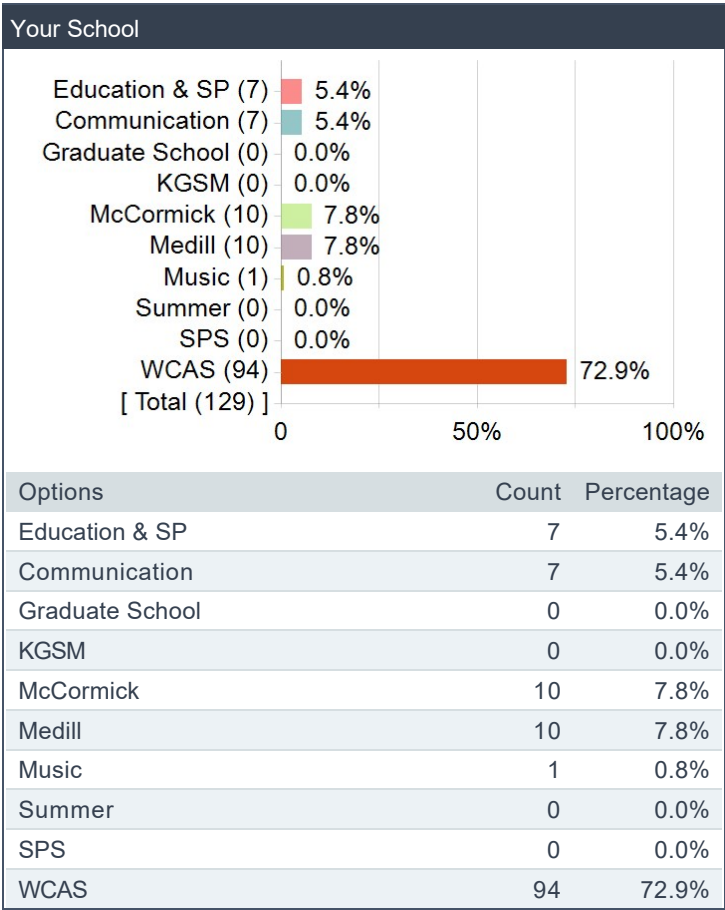
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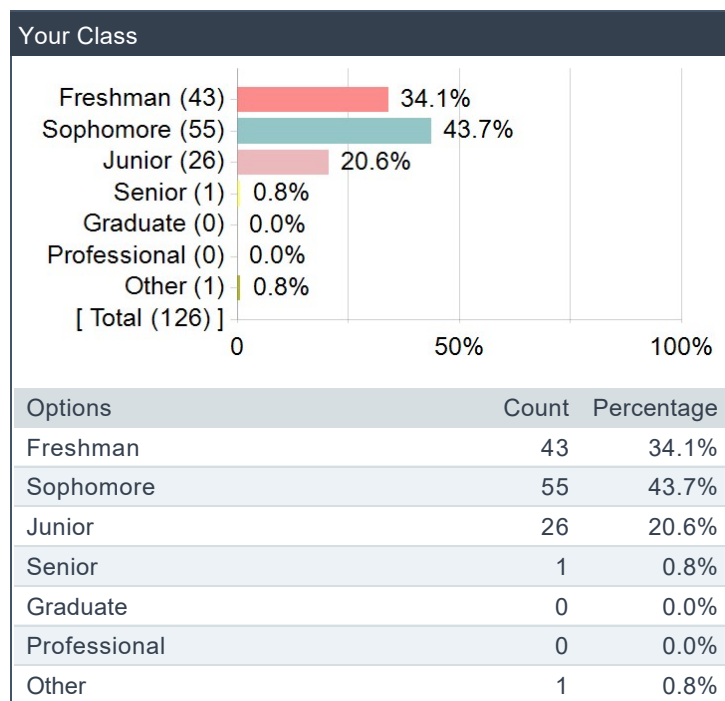
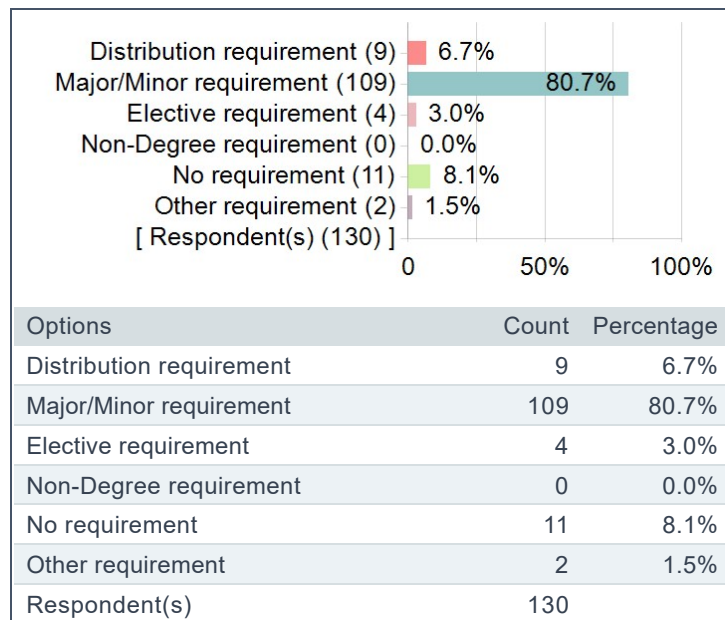
Course Evaluations

Teaching Assistant	Course
Matej Jungwirth	POLI_SCI_240-0_20: Intro International Relations

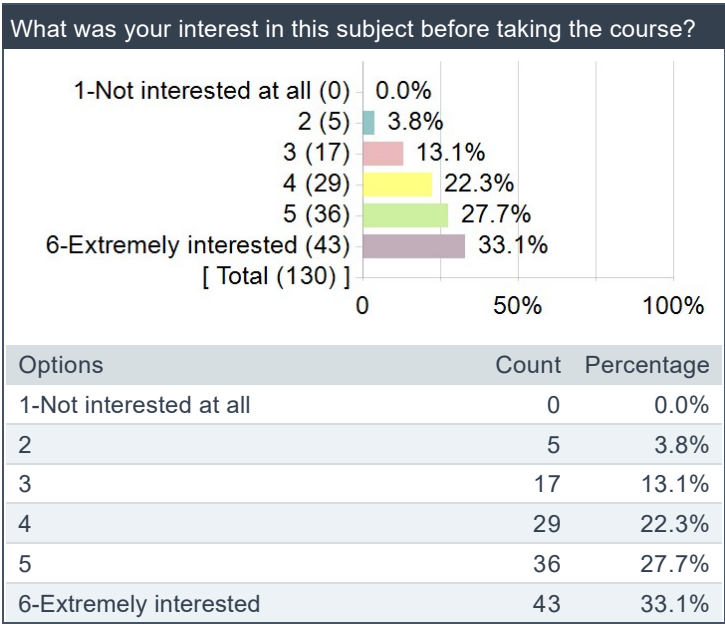
DEMOGRAPHICS

Your School



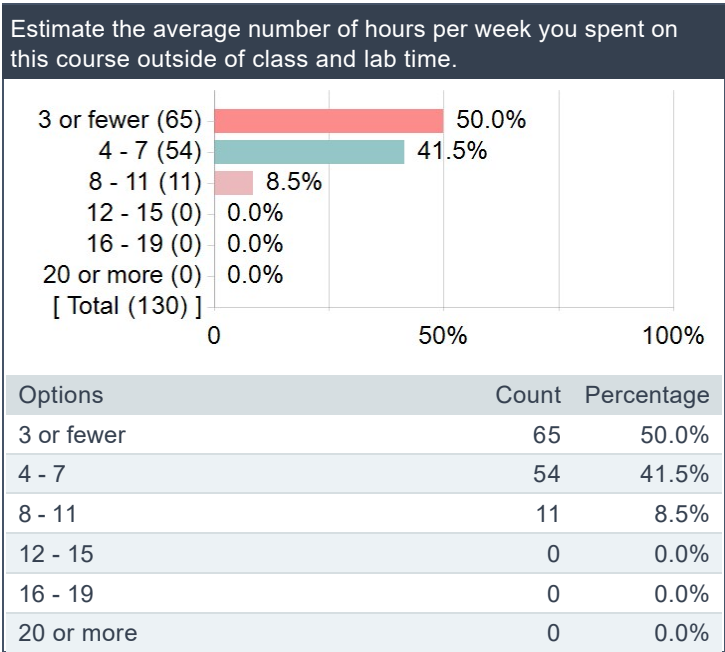
Your Class**What is your reason for taking the course? (mark all that apply)**

What was your interest in this subject before taking the course?



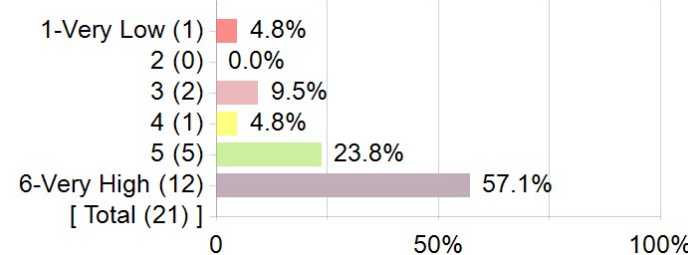
TIME-SURVEY QUESTION

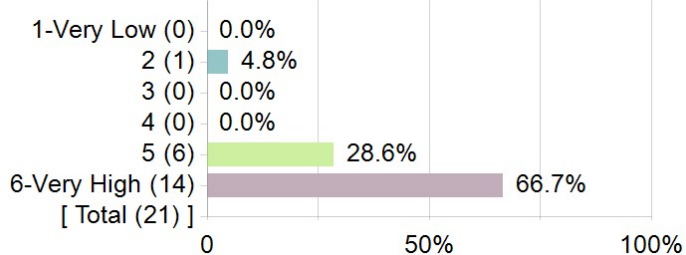
Estimate the average number of hours per week you spent on this course outside of class and lab time.



TA QUESTIONS

Please rate the TA on the following criteria:

1. The TA was able to answer the students' questions adequately.				
				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	1	4.8%	
2	2	0	0.0%	
3	3	2	9.5%	
4	4	1	4.8%	
5	5	5	23.8%	
6-Very High	6	12	57.1%	
Statistics			Value	
Response Count			21	
Mean			5.14	
Median			6.00	
Standard Deviation			1.35	

2. The TA was well prepared for each session.				
				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%	
2	2	1	4.8%	
3	3	0	0.0%	
4	4	0	0.0%	
5	5	6	28.6%	
6-Very High	6	14	66.7%	
Statistics			Value	
Response Count			21	
Mean			5.52	
Median			6.00	
Standard Deviation			0.93	

3. The TA communicated ideas in a clear manner.				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	1	4.8%	
2	2	1	4.8%	
3	3	2	9.5%	
4	4	2	9.5%	
5	5	3	14.3%	
6-Very High	6	12	57.1%	
Statistics			Value	
Response Count			21	
Mean			4.95	
Median			6.00	
Standard Deviation			1.53	
4. The TA showed strong interest in teaching the course.				
Options	Score	Count	Percentage	
1-Very Low	1	1	4.8%	
2	2	0	0.0%	
3	3	1	4.8%	
4	4	1	4.8%	
5	5	3	14.3%	
6-Very High	6	15	71.4%	
Statistics			Value	
Response Count			21	
Mean			5.38	
Median			6.00	
Standard Deviation			1.28	

OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

What are the primary strengths and weaknesses of the teaching assistant?

Comments
He's very good at connecting class concepts to real–world occurrences, which helps deepen understanding of the concepts, and he's very approachable to ask questions about the course.
All of the items above were strengths; Matej was very supportive and knowledgeable and encouraged good participation. At the same time, however, I felt that section participation grading as a whole was very unfair. I get that Matej (and the other TAs) don't just want to hand out 100s for free, but at some point, there is an extremely finite amount of time in section, and so it doesn't seem fair to say that literally nobody had a 100 by mid–quarter when 75% of the class participated thoughtfully each time (some several times in the same class). At that point, it's hard to know what to improve, as I didn't want to talk even more and keep other people from participating properly. This is a class–wide issue and not really a TA issue, but I think it should be addressed.
Matej was a good TA! I think his discussion sections were engaging. I think his grading was a little harsh in certain aspects but overall, he was a good TA that knew how to fuel interesting conversations about class material.
Very good at reinforcing course concepts during discussion sessions. I liked how he used current events to illustrate what we were talking about in class and allowed students to help lead class discussions.
Really good teacher but he was harsh grader with some stuff.
Dedicated to helping students learn more, creates environment where everyone is able to speak up and share their own thoughts
He really showed his interest in the topic and was encouraging to get us participating. He was always well prepared and gave reasonable feedback on the midterm.
Matej was a really good TA the one thing I would say was the participation scores were a little bit of a surprise to me and I was kind of unsure what his expectations were for participation. I feel like I often didn't have something to say in the discussion which became stressful because I would have to figure out something to say in order to participate.
Matej is definitely prepared for discussions but wasn't always able to answer questions very clearly.
Well organized, answered questions in a helpful way, emphasized key topics
Matej was very good at answering questions and was clearly highly knowledgeable on the subject. He also came to class ready with a succinct slides presentation every day and made the discussion that day simple to grasp. I also really appreciated how he worked in time to discuss real world international relations issues, as that helped me a lot when the abstract concepts we discussed would go over my head sometimes.
Good at forcing students to be engaged, but can sometimes be bad at facilitating conversations.
Matej is one of the better TAs I have had at Northwestern. Always extremely prepared, and encouraged students to think outside the box. Really pushed us, which I appreciated. Also had a clear passion for the field, and that showed in his work. His grading style is definitely critical, and I feel that it may've been harsh at times, but I understand that it comes from a place of pushing students to do their best work.
He is very clear and good at teaching about how current events in politics connect to what we are learning in class. However, he will not read student work and give feedback beforem submitting, which some of the other TAs did.
you are amazing! omg! never change! truly so incredible at what he does, he facilitates conversation well and encourages everyone to speak up in discussion, replied super quickly to emails, and always gave great examples which related to modern IR; one of the best TAs i've had at northwestern
Strengths: polite and on time for discussion sections Weaknesses: did not make it clear what he was looking for in exam answers, discussion participation, or the communications project; was not always able to answer questions about the course
Matej was good. But i feel like he marked unnecessarily hard compared to the other TAs for this course, which felt unfair. he did not always explain himself in his grading which was frustrating. If i do not get an A, I am fairly confident it will because he marked me harshly for no reason.
i loved having him as my TA! he did a great job getting to know us personally and connecting lecture topics to issues in the real world. no weaknesses
Matej was an extremely dedicated teaching assistant in my discussion section. He was well prepared with questions about the readings, and facilitated lots of discussion. What I enjoyed most was how he often connected concepts from class with current day events, helping us recognize the practical applicability of larger models or ideas in international relations.
Matej was extremely pleasant to talk to and memorized every student's name like right away. He understood us as students and even offered some really welcome advice at the end of discussion that tied together everything explored in the class. The implementation of current events every day helped us actively discuss and apply class concepts as they came up in real geopolitics, which was fantastic.
However, I feel like his expectations were somewhat arbitrary and unclear for both class discussions and exams. I felt like we had a

Comments

fantastic discussion section: barely any awkward silence or weak opinions. Everybody spoke up a lot and added a lot to the conversation, it was a fun little community. So it felt strange that, when he showed our participation grades, the average was somewhere near a low B or high C and the maximum score was an A-. Because someone talked at every available moment, it felt like one person talking would increase their grade at the cost of someone else's. Good example of the bargaining model, I guess. I also don't feel like the quality of contributions could've changed that much, so it added a layer of stress that changed the dynamic of discussions to be less conversational/seminar-style. It wouldn't be as big of a deal if participation wasn't weighted as high as it was. It also seemed like expectations for exams were less about applying our knowledge and more about regurgitating the textbook definitions, lest you lose several points off your exam for inaccuracy.

All that said, Matej is a great person and I'm glad he was my TA. It's hard for me to set aside the fact that my grade probably won't be what I want it to because he's a harsher grader than I'm used to, but that is not to say that I didn't enjoy coming to his section every day. He clearly wanted us to succeed and reiterated that every day, and his smiling face coming into section (at 4pm, which is normally my prime nap time) always made me look forward to going. He understood us as students, I just wish I understood him a bit more as a TA.

Report Comments

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Creation Date: **Wednesday, December 17, 2025**

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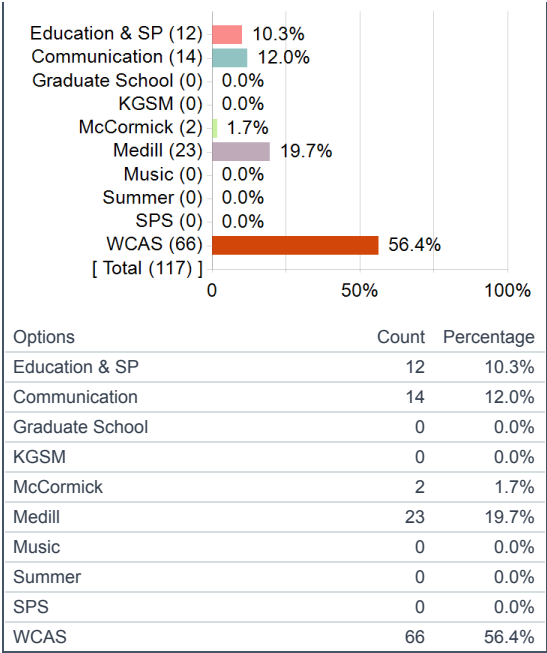
Course Evaluations

Teaching Assistant	Course
Matej Jungwirth	POLI_SCI_240-0_20: Intro International Relations

DEMOGRAPHICS

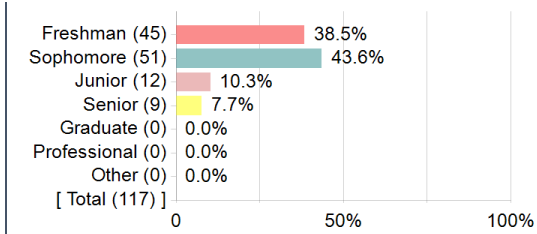
Your School

Your School



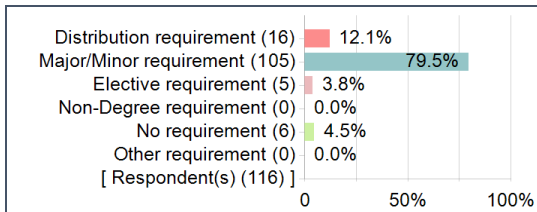
Your Class

Your Class



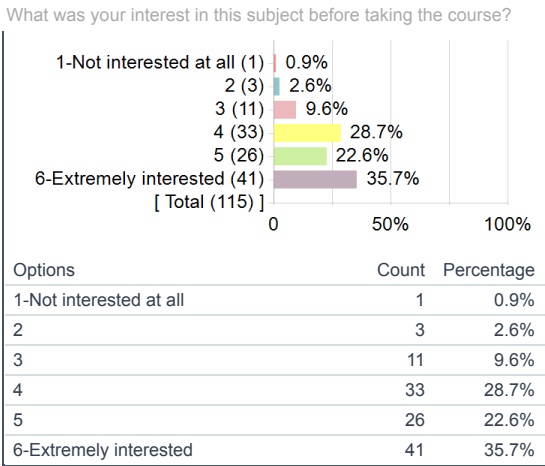
Options	Count	Percentage
Freshman	45	38.5%
Sophomore	51	43.6%
Junior	12	10.3%
Senior	9	7.7%
Graduate	0	0.0%
Professional	0	0.0%
Other	0	0.0%

What is your reason for taking the course? (mark all that apply)



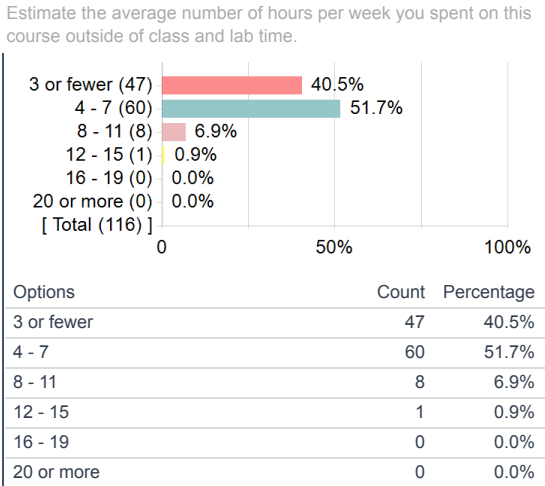
Options	Count	Percentage
Distribution requirement	16	12.1%
Major/Minor requirement	105	79.5%
Elective requirement	5	3.8%
Non-Degree requirement	0	0.0%
No requirement	6	4.5%
Other requirement	0	0.0%
Respondent(s)	116	

What was your interest in this subject before taking the course?



TIME-SURVEY QUESTION

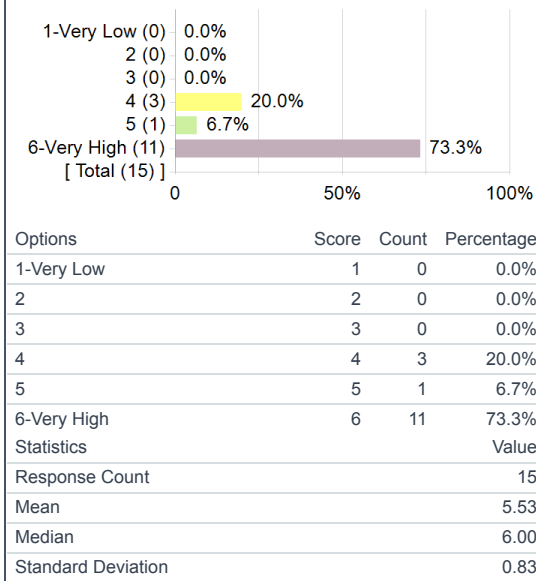
Estimate the average number of hours per week you spent on this course outside of class and lab time.



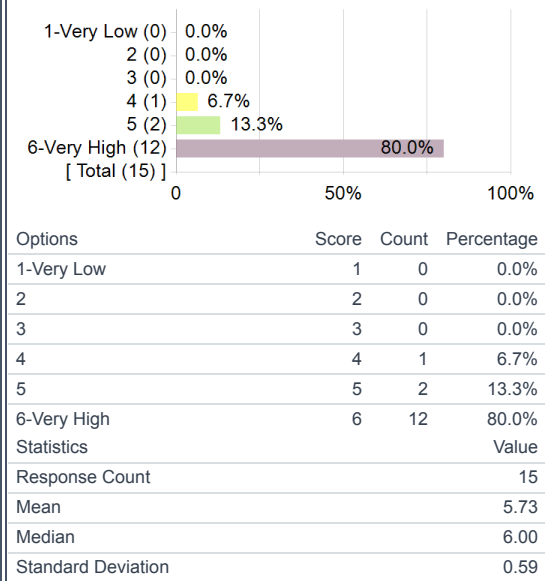
TA QUESTIONS

Please rate the TA on the following criteria:

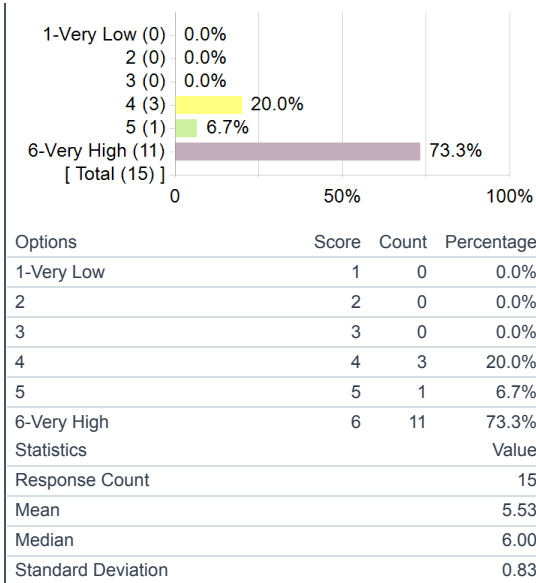
1. The TA was able to answer the students' questions adequately.



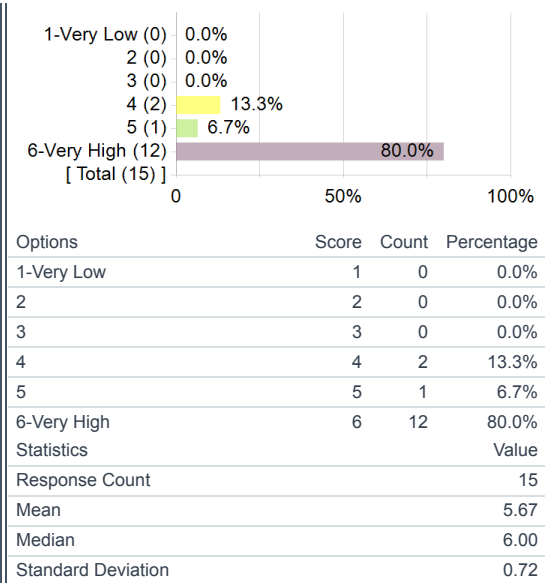
2. The TA was well prepared for each session.



3. The TA communicated ideas in a clear manner.



4. The TA showed strong interest in teaching the course.



OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

What are the primary strengths and weaknesses of the teaching assistant?

Comments

This TA did a really great job teaching the class. He always broke down important concepts that were unclear in lecture, and helped us understand the class more clearly as a whole. He did a great job fostering discussion too, allowing for a broad range of viewpoints to be shared and discussed, which made class a lot more interesting and educational. Lastly, his grading was fair and offered great feedback, which allowed me to understand my weaknesses and improve.

I liked the format of Matej's discussion sections, usually starting with a student-led presentation, a current event, and then a review of the content learned that week using an activity. It kept me very engaged. I like how Matej pushed my thinking during discussions, always showing us all sides of a situation or argument.

I like him, the only thing is that he has this accent so sometimes I couldn't really understand what he was saying. But this is not his fault at all and he can't do anything about it and honestly I got used to it pretty quickly anyways.

He was a very nice TA! always answering questions and showing availability to the students. I would definitely choose to have him again as a TA.

made discussion very clear and was always very helpful

I really liked Matej's discussion style. He made the environment feel comfortable and encouraged all of us to share our thoughts, even if we weren't completely confident in our answers. That helped me get more used to talking about political issues and thinking out loud, which was really valuable as a beginner. I also appreciated that he brought in current events and pointed us toward news sources, which helped make the material feel more connected to the real world, as well as encouraged us to keep track of current events.

While the final review was very thorough, I wish we had gotten a bit more guidance before the first exam, especially around what the short ID questions were supposed to look like. A little more practice or structure early on would have helped us know what to expect. But overall, Matej was engaged, supportive, and created a discussion space that made the class feel more approachable.

Matej was always available to answer questions and meet via office hours, which was very helpful! He also always tied in real-life examples of things discussed in lecture, and went over topics he thought were the most important for us to know, which I felt like really prepared me for the exams in class, and just being able to understand class better. He was clear in his instructions and also had a sense of humor, which I really appreciated!

Matej was very kind and willing to answer any questions we had. You could tell he was very interested in the course material and he was an engaging teacher. I felt that feedback on exams could've been communicated better, and some of the points off felt very arbitrary and nitpicky.

Matej was a great TA. He was great at communicating the material and helping us understand the concepts in the class. He's a bit of a tough grader.

I have only good things to say about Matej. I thoroughly enjoyed being a student in his discussion section. He was always well prepared, came up with so many fun and engaging activities and always kept us up to date with events in the news which were relevant to political science. He would make such a good professor, I would love to take a class with him. He is understanding, cares about his students and was so encouraging – helping us build up our confidence and give our transparent thoughts and ideas in the class. Also, I went for his office hours a couple of times and he was so happy and excited and willing to help. Thank you so much Matej – you truly are phenomenal.

I enjoyed the real-world discussion Matej included, and I felt he was very positive with his feedback and instruction in the class

Matej is very knowledgeable and interested in teaching, although he is very strict with participation grading, often times overly so. I consistently spoke around 4–5 times per discussion section and was unable to get an A in participation, without any feedback as to what I needed to do to receive that grade.